TOWNLIGHT BETA 1

# Townlight Portal Guide

Staff guide and technical reference

Local integration candidate · 2 November 2026
Existing signed installer and historical acceptance predate this integration

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# Townlight Portal guide

Townlight Beta 1 · local integration candidate

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The portal is a separately deployed suite capability for city pages and public meeting archives. It brings together a public Meetings archive, a completed Station recording and a Records release copy selected for publication. It does not add a tenth product. The existing signed Beta 1 installer and prior Sandbox evidence predate this local portal integration; they do not demonstrate that it is installed or publicly deployed. CivicCast remains separate.

# For staff: prepare and publish

1. In Meetings, publish the intended non-closed meeting archive. Review its title, scheduled time, agenda, packet, minutes and summary for public use.
2. Complete the corresponding Station recording and the Records request and release workflow. Records must have a current approved response, completed verified artifacts, a fulfilled request and an eligible managed release copy with verified lineage to that recording. Keep the original private.
3. Obtain the Records request UUID from the trusted staff workflow. A fulfilled request or prepared copy is not consent to publish.
4. A Wagtail superuser opens **Townlight publication** in `/admin/`, enters the request UUID, selects **Find approved releases**, and chooses the intended result. The form fills the archive, meeting, recording, request and release-copy IDs and expected SHA-256; approval remains unchecked. Review the selection and public content, select **Publish or update**, and explicitly approve. Confirm the resulting meeting page and approved file as a resident would. Ordinary Wagtail editors cannot use this publisher.
5. To remove it from the public archive, use the same selection and hash, choose **Withdraw**, and explicitly approve. Verify that the meeting and file are no longer accessible. Withdrawal hides the projection; retain source records and follow local retention policy.

An unsuccessful synchronization leaves the previous publication intact. Repeating a successful publication updates the same archive identity. If source records change, review and explicitly publish again; do not assume a source error withdraws a prior version.

# Residents

The meeting archive is at `/meetings/`. A published meeting page at `/meetings/<pk>/` presents the approved public meeting text and links to its release at `/meetings/<pk>/release/`. The approved release bytes are served with the selected MIME type and support byte ranges for video playback. Public text is filtered; requester contact information, internal notes, raw payloads, local paths and session proof are not public fields. This integration is for completed release copies, not live YouTube streaming. Station's separate CivicCast and YouTube workflows retain their own controls.

# Deployment and setup

The portal is a separate Wagtail deployment with its own database. Keep the native desktop runtime bound to loopback; do not expose it to the internet. Arrange a trusted private connection between the portal service and native runtime. The bridge accepts HTTPS origins or loopback HTTP origins; it does not follow redirects or use environment proxies. Restrict the server-side proof file to the portal service account and provision a native principal with both Meetings and Records permissions. Never put the proof in a browser, selection file, log or public document.

From the `portal` directory, use Python 3.13, install `python -m pip install --require-hashes -r requirements.lock`, run `python manage.py migrate`, `python manage.py setup_demo`, and `python manage.py createsuperuser`. For local evaluation run `python manage.py runserver 127.0.0.1:8000`. Set a unique `TOWNLIGHT_SECRET_KEY`, `TOWNLIGHT_DEBUG=0`, allowed hosts, TLS and appropriate static and media service before deployment. `TOWNLIGHT_DB` selects the database path; `TOWNLIGHT_BRAND` selects the site name. Protect the database and the private release directory together. `TOWNLIGHT_RELEASE_ROOT` is an absolute private directory outside public media; by default it is `private-releases` under the portal directory. These setup steps do not commission a hosted site or alter the already released installer.

Set `TOWNLIGHT_NATIVE_ORIGIN` to the trusted native origin and `TOWNLIGHT_NATIVE_PROOF_FILE` to an absolute private proof-file path. Sign in to the active native desktop with an account authorized for both modules. The active profile's `config/local-session.json` contains `session_hash`; this is an active session proof, not a durable service token. Copy it without displaying it into an absolute file in a directory already restricted to the portal service account. Replace both placeholders in this PowerShell command with the actual private paths:

```
[System.IO.File]::WriteAllText('<protected-absolute-path>\portal-proof.txt', (Get-Content -LiteralPath
'<active-profile>\config\local-session.json' -Raw | ConvertFrom-Json).session_hash,
[System.Text.UTF8Encoding]::new($false))
```

Refresh the protected proof after session expiry, sign-out, account change or credential change. Do not print or publish it. `TOWNLIGHT_DISPLAY_TIMEZONE` is an IANA time zone, defaulting to `UTC`. A private selection file can drive the same operation from the portal directory:

```
{"action":"publish","approve_publication":true,"archive_id":"00000000-0000-4000-8000-
000000000001","meeting_id":"00000000-0000-4000-8000-000000000002","recording_id":"00000000-0000-4000-8000-
000000000003","request_id":"00000000-0000-4000-8000-000000000004","release_copy_id":"00000000-0000-4000-8000-
000000000005","expected_release_sha256":"0000000000000000000000000000000000000000000000000000000000000000"}
```

These IDs and hash are placeholders. Run `python manage.py sync_townlight selection.json`. For withdrawal change `action` to `withdraw`, retain the selection fields and explicit approval, and verify removal. Restrict the selection file because it contains internal identifiers.

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# Prepare the candidate native runtime

The existing signed installer predates the portal bridge and does not include its native endpoints. Prepare a separate matching native runtime with the compatible Records, Meetings, Core, Access and Notice dependencies, normal activation, profile and database contracts. Do not patch the installed host runtime. From the suite source root, build the candidate wheel into a chosen output directory:

```
python -m pip wheel --no-deps --wheel-dir '<wheel-output>' desktop/runtime/python-services
```

In the separately prepared matching runtime, use its Python executable to install the built `civicsuite_runtime-0.1.0-py3-none-any.whl` with `python -m pip install --no-deps --force-reinstall '<wheel-output>\civicsuite_runtime-0.1.0-py3-none-any.whl'`. Preserve the intended profile, activation and database configuration; use `meetings-beta` or a higher applicable product profile. With that runtime's Python, start `python -m civicsuite_runtime.services`; it binds `127.0.0.1:15480` by default, or the port selected by `CIVICSUITE_RUNTIME_PORT`. Keep this private and provide the portal's server-side active proof and trusted origin as described above. Verify the authenticated selections endpoint with a real eligible request in the prepared environment before relying on publication. See verification and test inputs for the isolated acceptance runner and its explicit flags. These instructions do not upgrade the old installer or establish installed or public deployment acceptance.

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# Production service and reverse proxy

`runserver` is for local demonstration only. For deployment set `TOWNLIGHT_DEBUG=0`, a unique `TOWNLIGHT_SECRET_KEY` of at least 50 characters, `TOWNLIGHT_ALLOWED_HOSTS` to the canonical host, `TOWNLIGHT_BASE_URL` to the HTTPS origin, `TOWNLIGHT_CSRF_TRUSTED_ORIGINS` to that HTTPS origin, and `TOWNLIGHT_STATIC_ROOT` to the private deployment's collected-static directory. Run `python manage.py migrate`, then `python manage.py collectstatic`, and start `python serve.py --port 8000` under a supervised service account. Waitress binds only `127.0.0.1`; stop the supervised service cleanly before backup or maintenance. In production Django enables secure cookies, HTTPS redirect and HSTS.

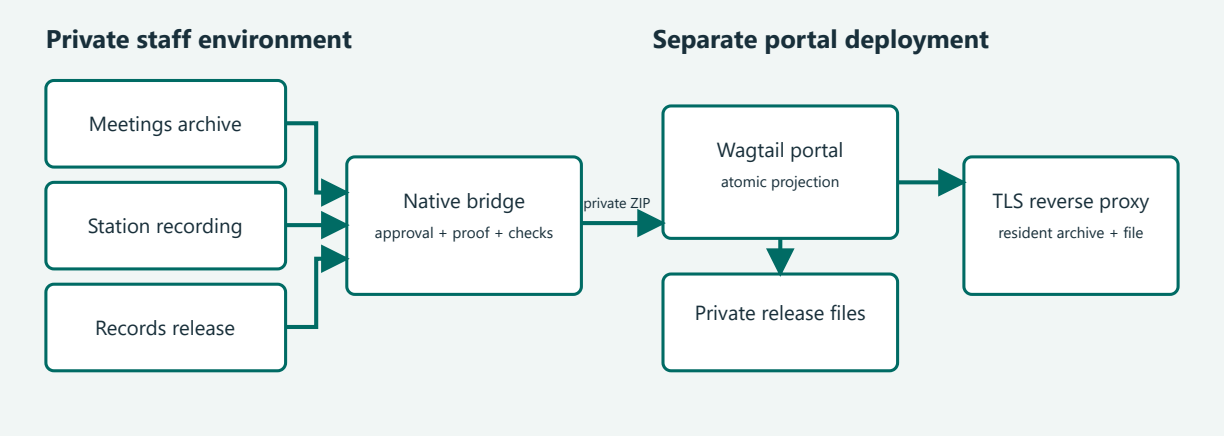
Terminate TLS in a reverse proxy on the same host. Set `TOWNLIGHT_TRUST_TLS_PROXY=1` only when the proxy removes client-supplied forwarded headers and sets its own HTTPS scheme and canonical Host. Never expose the native desktop port. Replace the example hostname, certificate and static directory with deployment values; serve only collected static files directly. The application handles all other routes, including approved release files:

```
server {
    listen 443 ssl;
    server_name town.example.gov;
    ssl_certificate /etc/ssl/town/fullchain.pem;
    ssl_certificate_key /etc/ssl/town/privkey.pem;
    location /static/ { alias /srv/townlight/static/; }
    location / {
        proxy_pass http://127.0.0.1:8000;
        proxy_set_header Host town.example.gov;
        proxy_set_header X-Forwarded-Proto https;
        proxy_set_header X-Forwarded-For "";
        proxy_set_header X-Forwarded-Host "";
        proxy_set_header Forwarded "";
    }
}
```

Keep the release directory outside every public static or media alias. Test the deployed HTTPS origin, admin, archive, range playback and explicit withdrawal using an approved synthetic record before use.

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# Architecture and API




Townlight portal architecture

The server calls `POST /desktop/v1/portal/bundle` with the selection JSON and the `X-Townlight-Session` header. The native principal must have both `civicclerk` and `civicrecords-ai` permissions. The returned ZIP contains `manifest.json` and, for publication, `release.bin`; the portal validates identity, hashes, sizes and allowable fields before an atomic update. Withdrawal carries a manifest without release bytes. The public projection includes meeting text and ID/hash provenance, not the private source payload. The bridge streams bundles and release

bytes through private files. Set `TOWNLIGHT_PORTAL_MAX_BYTES` consistently on both services; the default is 8 GiB and the maximum is 64 GiB. Allow private disk space for the bundle, staged copy and retained releases. The portal serves MP4 or octet-stream releases. This transport limit is not the end-to-end recording limit: the inherited Records managed-file receipt limits both originals and release copies to 2,147,483,647 bytes. At Station's default 6,000 kbps video rate, approximately 47 minutes reaches 2 GiB before accounting for audio and container overhead. Plan capture duration and bitrate before recording: for example, 2,000 kbps video plus audio for two hours is roughly 1.9 GB, depending on actual rates and overhead. Measure the resulting files and leave margin. The portal does not automatically transcode recordings. Consult the checked-in bridge and portal source for the exact contract and errors; do not log session proofs.

`python manage.py export_public <empty-directory>` exports published pages, metadata and approved release bytes with hashes. Secure the export as appropriate. Stop the portal and any synchronization before taking a consistent backup of the SQLite database and private release directory together; preserve private configuration and proof separately. Restore the matched database and releases to an isolated environment, set permissions and paths, then verify public pages, approved file hashes and withdrawal state before resuming service. A failed source sync preserves the prior projection; investigate permissions, source eligibility, IDs, expected hash, connection and proof-file access before retrying. An explicit withdrawal is necessary to remove a previously published item.

## Bundle contract and errors

For discovery, the trusted portal server can call `GET /desktop/v1/portal/selections?request_id=<UUID>` with `X-Townlight-Session`. The native actor must have both module permissions. The JSON response is `{"selections":[{"title":"<public archive title>","selection":{...}}]}`; each `selection` has all publication request fields, with `action` set to `publish` and `approve_publication` set to `false`. The Wagtail lookup uses this endpoint. Selecting a result supplies `request_id`, `release_copy_id` and `archive_id` as query parameters and fills the form without granting approval. An empty list means no eligible choice was returned; review source readiness and the request.

The JSON request requires `action` (`publish` or `withdraw`), boolean `approve_publication` set to `true`, UUIDs `archive_id`, `meeting_id`, `recording_id`, `request_id`, `release_copy_id`, and a 64-character lowercase `expected_release_sha256`. No extra request fields are accepted. Send it only from the trusted portal server with `X-Townlight-Session` containing its private session proof. For example, the supported operator command `python manage.py sync_townlight selection.json` reads the selection illustrated above and supplies that header from the protected proof file.

A successful publish returns `application/zip` with `manifest.json` and `release.bin`. Manifest version 1 contains `version`, `action`, `archive_id`, `meeting_id`, `recording_id`, `request_id`, `release_copy_id`, `original_sha256`, `title`, timezone-aware `scheduled_start`, `agenda`, `packet`, `minutes`, `summary`, and `release`. The `release` object contains `path` (`release.bin`), `sha256`, `size`, and `media_type`. Withdrawal returns a ZIP containing only `manifest.json` with `version`, `action` and `archive_id`. The portal validates the selection, manifest and bytes before changing its projection.

Invalid input or missing explicit approval is rejected; authorization failures are rejected by the native identity layer. Unavailable or changed source data produces HTTP 409 with `Publication sources unavailable or changed`; the portal command reports synchronization failure and retains the existing publication. Resolve the underlying staff-side source, identity, hash or connectivity issue before retrying. Do not publish error logs containing proof or private source details.

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# Source, license and demonstration data

The synthetic PrimeGov transport is for demonstration and does not contact a real tenant. Townlight-owned portal code is AGPL-3.0-only; vendored CivicCast code retains its Apache-2.0 notices. `/source/` offers allowlisted portal source and the native bridge from a repository checkout. Operators must provide the exact deployed corresponding source, modifications and dependencies as required by their license obligations. See the repository licenses, `portal/UPSTREAM.md`, and the existing terms and license; no city-specific legal terms are supplied here.

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# Subject index


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# Rebuild this guide

From the suite repository root, install the repository's Node dependencies (including Playwright), install a Playwright Chromium browser and make Python and Pandoc available on `PATH`. Run `node scripts/docs/build_portal_guide.cjs`. This rebuilds the portal guide HTML, editable Word, PDF and architecture PNG, and the portal verification reference HTML, from the checked-in Markdown, SVG, template and Word reference. To use an existing Playwright installation or Chromium executable, set `PLAYWRIGHT_MODULE` or `CHROMIUM_EXECUTABLE`; `PYTHON` selects a Python executable. The sibling product repositories are not needed to rebuild this guide.